

Getting started: Shanumkha Invoices & Stock

These steps set up the app on **one computer**. It takes about 15 minutes the first time. Everything is done with double-clicks; you don't need to type commands.

Step 1: Install Python (one time only)

Python is the free engine the app runs on.

1. Open **<https://www.python.org/downloads/>** in your browser.
2. Click the yellow **Download Python 3.x** button (any version 3.10 or newer is fine).
3. Open the downloaded file.
4. **Windows: on the first screen, tick ☒ "Add python.exe to PATH" at the bottom. This is important.**
5. Click **Install Now** and wait until it says *Setup was successful*. Close the installer.

(Mac: open the downloaded .pkg file and click Continue → Install.)

Step 2: Put the app folder on your computer

1. Find the downloaded **Shanumkha-Invoices.zip** (usually in *Downloads*).
2. **Windows:** right-click it → **Extract All...** → choose **Documents** → **Extract**. **Mac:** double-click the zip, then drag the **Shanumkha-Invoices** folder into **Documents**.
3. You now have a folder **Documents\Shanumkha-Invoices**. Don't run the app from inside the zip.

Your data will be saved inside this folder (in the `instance` folder). Don't delete it.

Step 3: Start the app

Windows: open the folder and double-click **Start-Windows.bat**.

- If a blue box says "*Windows protected your PC*": click **More info** → **Run anyway**. (It appears because the file is new to Windows, not because it is unsafe.)
- A black window opens. **The first time it prepares the app for 1–3 minutes (internet needed).**
- Your browser then opens the app at **<http://127.0.0.1:5000>**.

Mac: right-click **Start-Mac.command** → **Open** → **Open** (needed the first time only).

Keep the black window open while you use the app. Closing it stops the app. To start again tomorrow, double-click **Start-Windows.bat** again (it will be fast after the first time). If the browser didn't open, open it yourself and go to **http://127.0.0.1:5000**.

Step 4: Create the administrator login (first time only)

The first page asks you to **create the administrator**. Enter your name, a username and a password (at least 8 characters). **Write the password down somewhere safe.**

Step 5: Enter your business details

Click **Settings** in the menu and fill in your business name, address, GSTIN, phone, bank/UPI details and terms. Check the invoice prefix (**SCP**) and the default payment due days. Click **Save settings**. These details print on every invoice.

Step 6: Add logins for your team

Click **Users & access** → **+ Add user** for each person (partners, investors, staff):

1. Enter their name, a username and a starting password.
2. Choose a **Role**. This fills in suggested access.
3. In **Access to each section**, set each section to *No access*, *View only* or *View & edit*.
4. Click **Save**. Give them their username and password; they can change the password under **My account**.

Step 7: Add your products and stock

Either:

- **Products** → **+ Add product** for each item (name, code, HSN, UOM, price, GST %, opening stock, reorder level), **or**
- **Products** → **Upload stock file** and choose a PDF, Excel or Word purchase bill / stock list. Check the preview and click **Update stock**. The file `samples/stock-upload-template.xlsx` shows a simple layout you can fill in.

Step 8: Add customers and make your first invoice

1. **Customers** → **+ Add customer** (name, address, mail ID, phone, city).
2. Click **+ New invoice**, choose the customer, add items, set **Payment due (days)**, then **Save invoice**.
3. Click **Print / Save PDF** to print it or save it as a PDF. It then appears under **Dispatch**.

Everyday use

To...	Do this
Start the app	Double-click Start-Windows.bat (Mac: Start-Mac.command)
Stop the app	Close the black window
See money still to be received	Payments
See what went out of stock	Dashboard or Stock summary & stock out
Record a payment received	Payments → amount → Received

Backups: please do this every week

1. Double-click **Backup-Windows.bat** (Mac: **Backup-Mac.command**).
2. A copy of all your data is saved in the **backups** folder inside the app folder.
3. Copy the **backups** folder to a pen drive or Google Drive.

To restore a backup: stop the app, then copy `invoicer.sqlite3` and `secret_key` from the backup into the `instance` folder (replace the files there), and start the app again.

Getting a newer version later

1. Stop the app and make a backup (above).
2. Extract the new zip to a **new** folder.
3. Copy the **instance** folder from your old app folder into the new folder.
4. Start the app from the new folder. Your data and logins carry over automatically.

Using it from other locations

Right now the app runs on **this computer only**. People at other locations or on other Wi-Fi networks can't open it yet. To share it, the app needs to be put on an online server (for example PythonAnywhere or a cloud server). This is the next step and can be set up when you are ready.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
"Python is not installed"	Install Python (Step 1) and tick "Add python.exe to PATH" . Then restart the computer.
"Something went wrong during setup"	Check the internet connection. Delete the <code>.venv</code> folder inside the app folder and double-click Start again.
Browser says "can't reach this page"	The black window must be open. Wait a few seconds and refresh.
The black window shows an error about the address or port being in use	The app is already running in another black window. Use that one, or close it first.
Forgot the administrator password	Open the app folder, click the address bar, type <code>cmd</code> and press Enter. In the window type <code>.venv\Scripts\flask --app run create-admin</code> and follow the questions.
Someone is locked out	They typed a wrong password 5 times. Wait 15 minutes, or the admin clicks Unlock under Users & access .